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Product Discovery, Market & User Research- Rapido

This is a group project. Each group is required to submit a single **assignment.**

Project Brief:

- You are a **PM at Rapido** (India's leading on-demand bike taxi app) and are in charge of the **supply pod**.

- As the popularity of bike taxis has risen, local auto rickshaw drivers have been viewing Rapido as a threat and have been creating friction for new drivers either by harassing them etc.

- This has led to the supply growth slowing down quarter on quarter.

- Your P0 goal is to figure out how to solve this problem in the short & medium term.

- With this context, craft the **top 5 questions** (their follow-up questions) that you would ask current Rapido drivers in a user

research interview.

- Execute the **In-depth Interviews** (talk to at-least 5 subjects)
- Summarise your insights & inferences supported by direct quotes

Performed by:

Arpit Sahay

Shrihari Upadhyaya



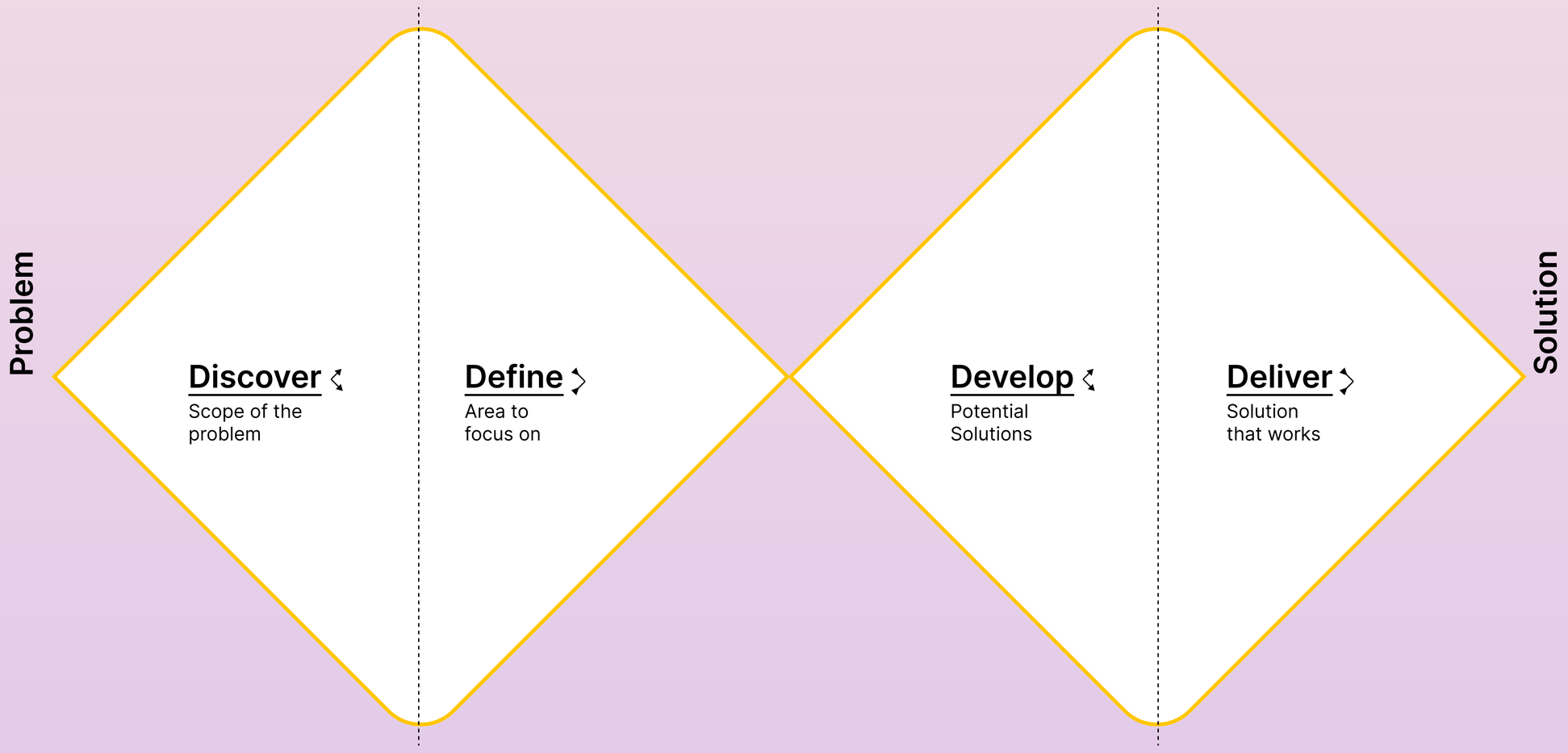


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Research Goals 🎯

- Understanding the nature and impact problem statement
- How it affects Rapido, it’s captains and it’s users
- Identify potential solutions to tackle this situation

Double Diamond Design Process 💎



Double Diamond Design process is a framework for innovation and design which can also be used to define and solve product related problems and deliver efficient and effective solution to a problem. We can make use of this model to define each elements of model with context to this case study.

- **Discover:** Understanding the problem and pain points of Rapido Captains by conducting their interviews.
- **Define:** Analyzing the captain responses and identifying the key problems to focus and solve it.
- **Develop:** Developing potential solutions based on research data and models to solve the issues faced by Rapido captains.
- **Deliver:** Implement and test the solutions which are effective and efficient based on monitoring and feedback

Problem Definition 🎯

moneycontrol

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After auto drivers' protest, Karnataka transport department to crack down on bike taxis in Bengaluru

Karnataka transport department plans to launch a special enforcement drive against bike taxis in Bengaluru from July 5. Bike Taxi Welfare Association opposes the move, citing a High Court directive urging the state government to protect bike taxi operators by cracking down on those unlawfully hindering their services.

Read more↗

ChristinMathewPhilip
@ChristinMP_

Bengaluru auto and taxi drivers staged a protest on July 4 demanding a ban on bike-taxis.

moneycontrol.com/technology/aft...
pic.twitter.com/w5XKntQvOS



ChristinMathewPhilip @@ChristinMP_ · Jul 4

🚨 After auto drivers' protest, Karnataka transport department to crack down on bike taxis in Bengaluru

moneycontrol.com/technology/aft...

@tdkarnataka @RLR_BTM
pic.twitter.com/AIoEgbMixi

55 Retweets **321** Likes

Read more↗

Amisha Aggarwal 📌
@awwmishaaa

Never taking a Rapido bike again :)
pic.twitter.com/EAwkyCjfb1



146 Retweets **3.6K** Likes

The conflict originated from the auto drivers of Karnataka against bike taxis arguing that there operations are attacking the livelihood of local taxis. The main concerns raised by them are safety concerns while using bike-taxis and often cite that the operations of such platforms on marginally low costs is not sustainable and hurt the local taxi drivers.

This sentiment of dissatisfaction has reached various cities of country however, the situation is very tense specifically in Bengaluru. The Karnataka government did took some actions against these protests, like in 2021 they instructed Rapido to scrap their e-bike taxis citing safety concerns.

Ever since the conditions have only worsen where multiple Rapido drivers have reported physical assaults and harassments cases by the local taxi drivers. This has led to a situation of fear among drivers (‘Captain’) at Rapido to even continue working.

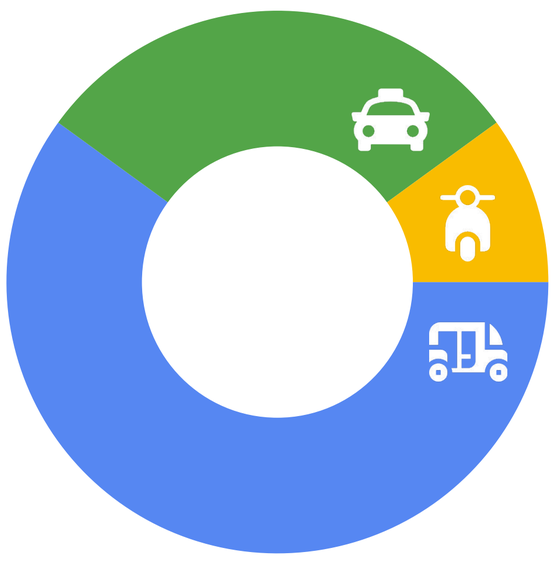
All these factors have led to a decline in the total drivers supply for Rapido mostly due to safety concerns.

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Problem Scope 💡

40%

people opt for
shared mobility
for daily commute



1M+

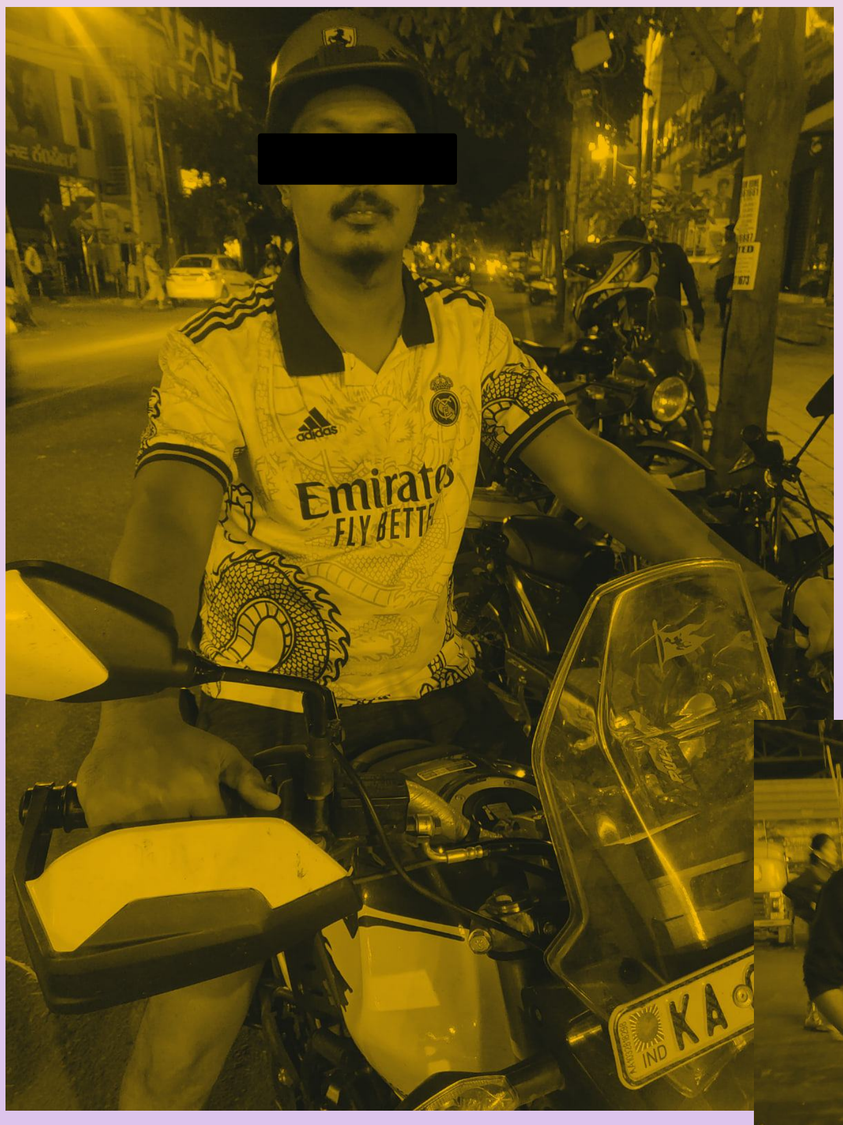
Drivers are
working in Rapido
as Captain

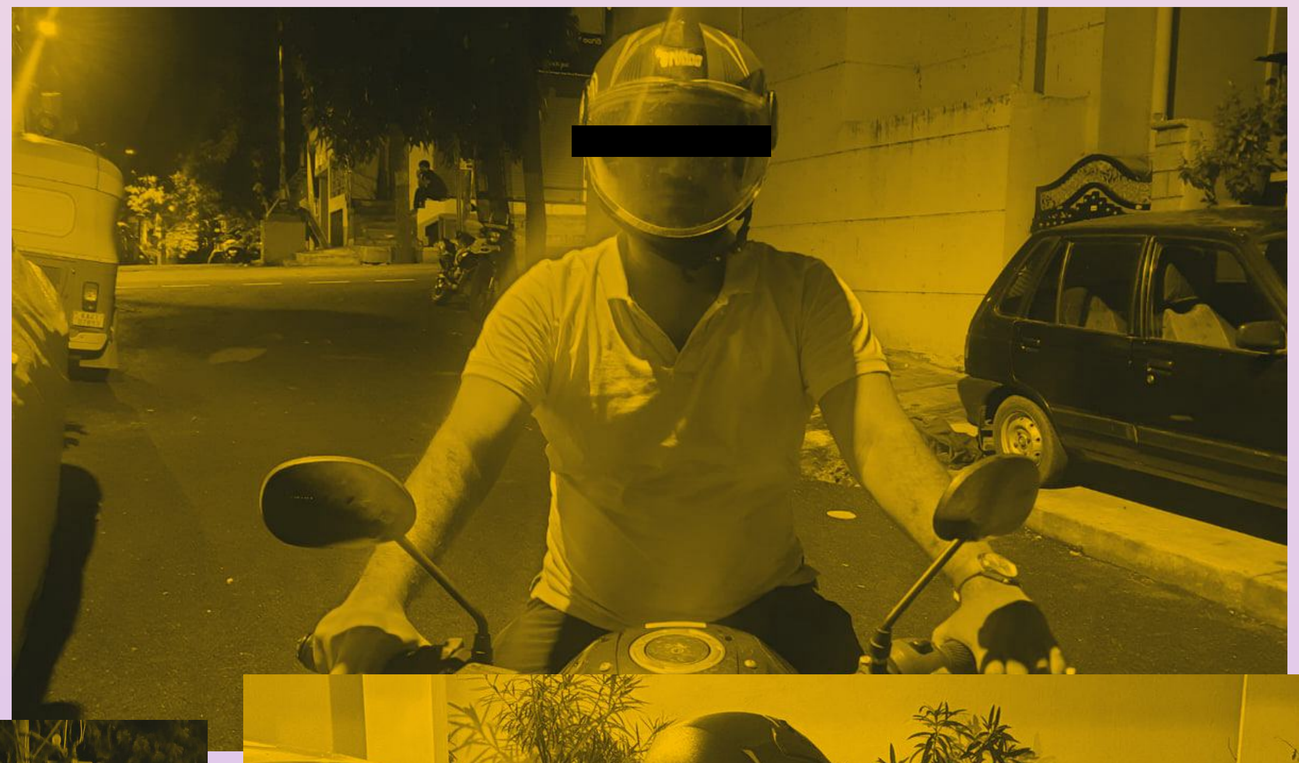
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So, we asked local Rapido drivers some questions....

- How many rides do you get in a week?
- What challenges do you face from customers?
- There are various alternatives like Uber, Ola, etc. Why Rapido?
- Have you encountered any hostile situation with local auto rickshaw drivers?
- What are your expectations from Rapido

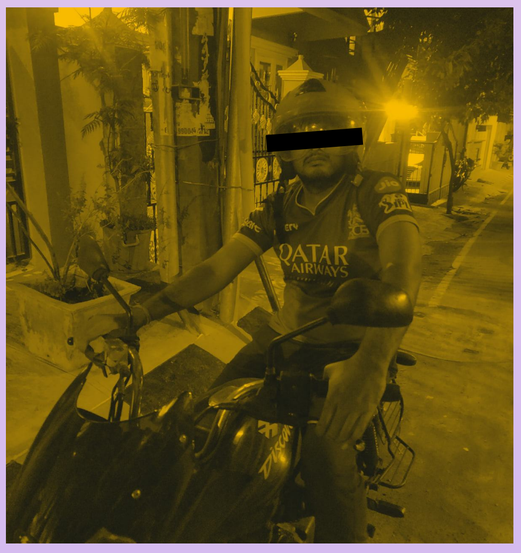
Faces hidden for privacy













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Meet Manjunath 👀

Manjunath has been captain for more than 2 years. He joined Rapido to use his own bike as taxi and support his family.

Demographics 📍

Age: 27

Place: Tumkur

Relationship: Married

Prior Occupation: Fisherman

Stats 📊

Daily Hours: 7-8 Hours

Weekly Rides: 15-20 Rides

Monthly Income: 19-22K INR

Captain Since: 2 Years, 4 Months

What challenges do you face from customers?

Customers provide incorrect pick up and drop off locations which causes a lot of issues. Sometimes, customers can be rude, and that can be really hurtful.

Have you encountered any hostile situations?

I encountered a hostile situation where I was beaten up, and my bike was damaged by a group of auto drivers.

What are your expectations from Rapido?

They should lower the platform fees. Insurance coverage for us bikes should also be included. They should also reduce the commission charges taken from each ride.

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Meet Pavan 👀

Pavan is a veteran Rapido driver, working for almost 3 years using it as a side income source while also running a *Kirana* shop.

Demographics 📍

Age: 29

Place: Bengaluru North

Relationship: Married

Prior Occupation: Shop Owner (still working)

Stats 📊

Daily Hours: 4-5 Hours

Weekly Rides: 8-10 Rides

Monthly Income: 8-10K INR

Captain Since: 3 Years, 2 Months

What challenges do you face from customers?

Customers are often less cooperative during heavy traffic.

Have you encountered any hostile situations?

I was caught by a group of auto drivers and had to go to the nearest police station to resolve the conflict. During that time, they punctured my bike.

What are your expectations from Rapido?

They should reduce the commission charges taken from each ride. Providing higher insurance coverage would benefit Rapido captains.

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Meet Yashwanth 👀

Yashwanth is a UG student working as a rapido capatin to earn some extra pocket money since he has his own bike.

Demographics 📍

Age: 25

Place: Ballari

Relationship: Single

Prior Occupation: N/A

Stats 📊

Daily Hours: 5-6 Hours

Weekly Rides: 12-15 Rides

Monthly Income: 12-15K INR

Captain Since: 6.5 Months

What challenges do you face from customers?

Ride cancellation close to the pickup point can be really frustrating.

Have you encountered any hostile situations?

I have received many warnings and scoldings from various people.

What are your expectations from Rapido?

Commission Charges: The commission charges deducted from each ride can be quite high.

Reduced Ride Availability: If we cancel one or more rides, we often get fewer ride requests afterward.

Platform Fees: The platform fees can also be a burden.

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Meet Shrikanth 👀

Shrikanth is currently a software engineer. He says he want to improve his social network so he take rides on his way to office and back home!

Demographics 📍

Age: 28

Place: Raichur

Relationship: Married

Prior Occupation: Software Engineer (still working)

Stats 📊

Daily Hours: 2 Hours

Weekly Rides: 4-6 Rides

Monthly Income: 8K INR

Captain Since: 1 Year

What challenges do you face from customers?

Incorrect pickup and drop-off locations can be problematic.

Have you encountered any hostile situations?

I have never come across such situations because I usually ride without a map holder and wear a proper riding helmet, so people don’t think I am a Rapido captain.

What are your expectations from Rapido?

They should also increase the incentives. Insurance coverage for our bikes should be included.

Empathy Map 🫶

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What they Say

Reduce Platform fees

Provide Insurance Covers

We want incentives

We don’t have security from Rapido

We can be physically attacked at any moment



Constant fear on safety

What they Think

Customer will cancel the ride last moment

What they Feel

We are not paid enough

Frustration with customer

What they Do

Work at Rapido as side income source

Try to hide association with Rapido

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Potential Solutions 🧠

Based on all the interviews conducted, we can sort and find the following potential solutions (categorized by short and long term):

Short-term Solution

- Mindfulness: Rapido captains have been gone through a lot in recent times, the first step should be taken towards acknowledging the current situation which can make them feel a sense of belongingness and recognition by the company.

- Safety Helpline: A special safety helpline to aid Rapido captain in current situation likely with the help of local police authority until the tensions cool down.

Long-term Solution

- Rider Earning Model: The earnings for Rapido captain should be re-revised likely through reduction in commissions, platform charges or introducing a better surge pricing where both customers and captain do not feel at loss.

- Government Approval: Currently the Government is not favoring the operations of bike taxi in full confidence. The most important part of focus should be drawn toward getting 100% legal approval to operate.

- Perks for Captain: Many Rapido captains expressed their dissatisfaction with Rapido due to various reasons, one of the most prominent being insurance covers. Rapido should look into building a rewarding experience for their captain. This does not just include insurance covers, many non-monetary benefits can also be introduced so captains feel working at Rapido a pleasant experience.

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We really hope that all the Rapido drivers are safe 💛

Thanks!

Product Discovery, Market & User Research- Rapido

By Arpit Sahay and

Shrihari Upadhyaya

Tech stack used:



Rapido Captain Interview

Click here for detailed transcript